

Tehillah Photography

Full Developer & Content Documentation

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Instagram: [@tillah.jpg](https://www.instagram.com/tillah.jpg)

Location: Birmingham, United Kingdom

Framework: Next.js 16 (App Router) · TypeScript · Tailwind CSS

Animations: Framer Motion

Deployment: Vercel

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1. Project Structure & File Map

Every file in the project and what it does

The project lives at `/Users/tmuchato/portfolio_2`. Below is the full file tree with a description of every important file.

File / Folder	Purpose
<code>app/layout.tsx</code>	Root layout — loads fonts (Tenor Sans, Roboto), sets global SEO metadata, wraps all pages in <code>ConditionalShell</code>
<code>app/globals.css</code>	Global CSS — imports Tailwind, defines CSS variables for colours, scrollbar styling
<code>app/page.tsx</code>	Home page — hero slideshow, intro strip, category cards, quote section, testimonials, CTA
<code>app/about/page.tsx</code>	About page — Tehillah's bio, photographer portrait, values section
<code>app/portfolio/page.tsx</code>	Portfolio page — header + wraps <code>PortfolioGallery</code> in a <code>Suspense</code> boundary
<code>app/services/page.tsx</code>	Services page — four service blocks with pricing, inclusions, and enquiry CTAs
<code>app/contact/page.tsx</code>	Contact page — contact info, social links, enquiry form
<code>app/admin/page.tsx</code>	Admin portal — full image management UI (login, dashboard, add/remove photos)
<code>app/api/photos/route.ts</code>	Public API — GET <code>/api/photos</code> → returns all photos from <code>data/photos.json</code>
<code>app/api/admin/photos/route.ts</code>	Admin API — GET (list) and POST (add by URL) photos. Requires <code>x-admin-password</code> header
<code>app/api/admin/photos/[id]/route.ts</code>	Admin API — DELETE <code>/api/admin/photos/:id</code> — removes from JSON and deletes uploaded file
<code>app/api/admin/upload/route.ts</code>	Admin API — POST multipart upload → saves file to <code>public/uploads/</code> , adds to JSON
<code>components/Navigation.tsx</code>	Sticky nav bar — transparent on hero, solid on scroll, animated mobile menu
<code>components/Footer.tsx</code>	Site footer — brand name, nav links, social links, copyright
<code>components/ConditionalShell.tsx</code>	Wraps all pages — shows Nav+Footer on public pages, hides them on <code>/admin</code>
<code>components/HeroSlideshow.tsx</code>	Full-screen auto-advancing image carousel on the home page
<code>components/CategoryCard.tsx</code>	Reusable card component used in the home page category grid
<code>components/PortfolioGallery.tsx</code>	Filterable masonry gallery — fetches photos from API, handles lightbox

components/Lightbox.tsx	Full-screen image viewer — keyboard navigation (← → Esc), counter, caption
components/CTASection.tsx	Reusable call-to-action section — supports light and dark variants
components/ContactForm.tsx	Enquiry form — controlled inputs, success state, reads ?service= from URL
components/TestimonialSlider.tsx	Animated quote carousel with navigation dots
components/FadeIn.tsx	Reusable motion wrapper — fades + slides content in when it enters the viewport
lib/photos.ts	Shared TypeScript types: Photo interface and Category type. Hero image data.
lib/adminPhotos.ts	Server-side file helpers — readPhotos(), writePhotos(), addPhoto(), removePhoto()
data/photos.json	Source of truth for all gallery photos — edited by the admin portal
.env.local	Environment variables — set ADMIN_PASSWORD here to change the admin login
next.config.ts	Next.js config — allows images from images.unsplash.com
.claude/launch.json	Dev server config for the Claude preview tool

2. Pages — What They Do & How to Edit

Each page, its URL, and exactly what to change

Home Page

File	app/page.tsx
URL	/
Description	The landing page. Contains: full-screen hero slideshow, intro quote strip, 4 category cards, a full-bleed quote section, testimonial slider, and a dark CTA.

How to edit:

Tagline / intro quote	Find the <code><h2></code> tag around line 65. Edit the text between the tags.
'London — Est. 2023' label	Search for Birmingham — Est. 2023 and update the text.
Category card text	Edit the categories array near the top of the file — change title, description, or href for each card.
Category card images	Change the imageSrc URL in each category object. Use an Unsplash URL or <code>/uploads/</code> path.
Full-bleed quote	Find the paragraph starting with “A photograph is the pause button...” and edit freely.
Hero background images	Edit lib/photos.ts — the heroImages array at the bottom of the file.

About Page

File	app/about/page.tsx
URL	/about
Description	Tehillah's personal story, photographer portrait image, and three values (Presence, Authenticity, Artistry).

How to edit:

Bio paragraphs	Edit the <code><p></code> tags inside the space-y-5 div — your full story lives here.
Main heading	Find I'm the invisible photographer. and edit the h2 block.
Photographer portrait	Change the src on the Image component around line 45. Upload your own photo via the admin portal and use /uploads/filename.jpg .
Hero background image	Change the src on the first Image component (the full-width hero at the top).
Values section	Find the array with Presence, Authenticity, Artistry — edit title and body for each.

Page SEO description	Edit the description field inside export const metadata at the top.
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Portfolio Page

File	app/portfolio/page.tsx
URL	/portfolio
Description	A filterable masonry gallery. The actual gallery logic lives in components/PortfolioGallery.tsx. Photos are fetched live from /api/photos (which reads data/photos.json).

How to edit:

Page headline / intro text	Edit the h1 and paragraph near the top of app/portfolio/page.tsx.
Gallery photos	Use the admin portal at /admin — add or remove photos there. No code changes needed.
Filter categories	Edit the filters array in components/PortfolioGallery.tsx .

Services Page

File	app/services/page.tsx
URL	/services
Description	Four service sections — Proposals, Graduations, Birthdays, Studio — each with a description, inclusions list, starting price, and an enquire button.

How to edit:

Service title / tagline / description	Edit the services array near the top. Each object has: id, title, tagline, description, included[], from, image, imageAlt.
Pricing (e.g. £395)	Change the from field in each service object.
Inclusions list	Edit the included array inside each service object — add or remove bullet points.
Service images	Change the image URL in each service object.
Number of services	Add or remove entire objects from the services array.

Contact Page

File	app/contact/page.tsx
URL	/contact
Description	Contact information (email, location, social links) on the left. Enquiry form on the right. The form uses ContactForm component.

How to edit:

Email address	Search for tehillahmuchato@gmail.com — update in both the href and the display text.
Location text	Find Birmingham, United Kingdom and edit.
Instagram / TikTok links	Find the two <a> tags with href to Instagram/TikTok and update the href and label.
Form event type options	Edit the eventTypes array in components/ContactForm.tsx .
Page heading	Find Let's begin your story. and edit the h1 block.

3. Components — Full Reference

Every reusable component, its props, and how to customise it

Navigation

`components/Navigation.tsx`

Sticky navigation bar. Transparent over the hero image, transitions to cream/solid after 60px of scrolling. Collapses to a hamburger menu on mobile with a full-screen animated overlay.

How to customise:

Nav links: Edit the `links` array at the top — change href or label.

Logo name: Find **Tehillah** inside the Link component and change it.

Scroll threshold: Change `window.scrollY > 60` to a different pixel value.

Solid colour: Change `bg-[#F5F1E8]` in the `navBg` variable.

Footer

`components/Footer.tsx`

Dark footer (Deep Slate background) with brand name, navigation links, social links, a 'Book a Session' button, and copyright.

How to customise:

Social links: Edit the `socialLinks` array — update href and label.

Nav links in footer: Edit the `navLinks` array.

Copyright text: Find the © line near the bottom.

Footer colour: Change `bg-[#1C2A5A]` on the footer element.

HeroSlideshow

`components/HeroSlideshow.tsx`

Full-screen auto-advancing carousel. Cycles through images every 6 seconds with a fade + subtle scale animation. Shows slide indicators at the bottom and a scroll hint on the right.

How to customise:

Hero images: Edit the `heroImages` array in `lib/photos.ts` — each entry has `src`, `alt`, and `label`.

Slide interval: Change `setInterval(next, 6000)` — value is in milliseconds.

Main tagline: Find **Capturing the moments that define your story** inside the `h1` and edit.

Sub-tagline: Find **Luxury event & portrait photography across Birmingham and beyond**.

Overlay darkness: Change `bg-black/35` on the overlay div — higher number = darker.

CategoryCard

`components/CategoryCard.tsx`

A portrait-aspect image card with a title overlay and description below. Used in the home page category grid. Hover animates a zoom on the image.

Props:

Prop	Type	Description
<code>title</code>	<i>string</i>	Category name displayed over the image
<code>description</code>	<i>string</i>	Short text shown below the image
<code>imageSrc</code>	<i>string</i>	URL of the card image
<code>imageAlt</code>	<i>string</i>	Alt text for accessibility
<code>href</code>	<i>string</i>	Link destination when the card is clicked
<code>index</code>	<i>number</i>	Used to stagger the fade-in animation delay

How to customise:

Aspect ratio: Change `aspect-[3/4]` on the image wrapper div.

Hover zoom amount: Change `group-hover:scale-105` on the Image.

PortfolioGallery

`components/PortfolioGallery.tsx`

Fetches photos from `/api/photos` on mount. Renders a filterable masonry grid. Clicking a photo opens the Lightbox. Active filter is synced to the URL query string (`?category=proposals`).

How to customise:

Filter tabs: Edit the `filters` array — add or rename categories (must match Category type in `lib/photos.ts`).

Grid columns: Change `columns-1 sm:columns-2 lg:columns-3` on the masonry div.

Gap between images: Change `gap-4 md:gap-6` on the masonry div.

Lightbox

`components/Lightbox.tsx`

Full-screen image overlay. Keyboard navigable — left/right arrows to navigate, Escape to close. Shows a counter (e.g. 3 / 16) and the image alt text as a caption.

Props:

Prop	Type	Description
<code>photo</code>	<i>Photo</i> <i>null</i>	Currently displayed photo — null means lightbox is closed
<code>photos</code>	<i>Photo</i> []	The full filtered array used for prev/next navigation
<code>onClose</code>	<i>() => void</i>	Called when the user closes the lightbox
<code>onPrev</code>	<i>() => void</i>	Called to go to the previous image
<code>onNext</code>	<i>() => void</i>	Called to go to the next image

How to customise:

Background opacity: Change `bg-black/95` on the outer motion div.

CTASection

`components/CTASection.tsx`

A reusable full-width call-to-action block with a heading, subheading, and two buttons. Supports a light (cream) and dark (slate) colour variant.

Props:

Prop	Type	Description
<code>heading</code>	<code>string</code>	Main headline text
<code>subheading</code>	<code>string</code>	Supporting paragraph text
<code>primaryLabel</code>	<code>string</code>	Text for the primary (solid) button
<code>primaryHref</code>	<code>string</code>	Link for the primary button
<code>secondaryLabel</code>	<code>string</code>	Text for the secondary (outlined) button
<code>secondaryHref</code>	<code>string</code>	Link for the secondary button
<code>dark</code>	<code>boolean</code>	true = slate background, false (default) = cream background

ContactForm

`components/ContactForm.tsx`

Controlled enquiry form. Reads `?service=` from the URL to pre-select the session type. Shows a personalised thank-you message on submission (currently a simulated delay — connect to a real API or service like Resend for live emails).

How to customise:

Event type options: Edit the `eventTypes` array at the top of the file.

Service pre-fill mapping: Edit the `serviceMap` object — keys match the `?service=` query param values.

Connect to real email: Replace the `await new Promise(...)` mock delay with a fetch to an email API (e.g. Resend, EmailJS, Formspree).

TestimonialSlider

`components/TestimonialSlider.tsx`

Auto-manually-navigated quote carousel. Displays client testimonials with name and event label. Navigation via prev/next arrows and indicator dots.

How to customise:

Testimonials: Edit the `testimonials` array — each entry has quote, name, and event.

Add more testimonials: Append another object to the array — the dots will update automatically.

FadeIn

`components/FadeIn.tsx`

Thin wrapper around Framer Motion's `whileInView`. Fades and slides content upward when it scrolls into the viewport. Used throughout all pages to animate sections.

Props:

Prop	Type	Description
<code>children</code>	<code>ReactNode</code>	Any content to animate
<code>delay</code>	<code>number (optional)</code>	Seconds to delay the animation start — default 0

How to customise:

Animation distance: Change `y: 20` in the initial prop — larger = more travel.

Duration: Change `duration: 0.8` in the transition prop.

Viewport margin: Change `margin: "-60px"` — controls how early the animation triggers.

ConditionalShell

`components/ConditionalShell.tsx`

Reads the current pathname. On `/admin` routes: renders a dark wrapper with no nav or footer. On all other routes: renders Navigation, the page content, and Footer.

Props:

Prop	Type	Description
<code>children</code>	<code>ReactNode</code>	The page content

How to customise:

Add more admin-style routes: Add more conditions to the `isAdmin` check (e.g. `pathname.startsWith('/dashboard')`).

4. Admin Portal — Usage Guide

How to log in, manage photos, and change the password

URL: `localhost:3000/admin` (or your domain/admin in production)

Logging In

The admin portal is protected by a password. The default password is **admin123**. To change it, open `.env.local` in the project root and update the value:

```
ADMIN_PASSWORD=your_new_password_here
```

Then restart the dev server (**npm run dev**). On Vercel, set this as an Environment Variable in your project settings — you do not need `.env.local` in production.

Dashboard Overview

After logging in you will see:

- **Stat cards** — total photo count per category. Click any card to filter the grid.
- **Search bar** — filters photos by their description/alt text in real time.
- **Photo grid** — all gallery images. Click any photo to preview full-size. Hover to reveal the Remove button.
- **Add Photo panel** (right side / bottom on mobile) — two tabs: Upload File and Paste URL.
- **View Site**  button — opens the live portfolio in a new tab.
- **Sign Out** — clears the session from the browser.

Adding a Photo — Upload File

1. Click the **Upload File** tab in the Add Photo panel.
2. Drag and drop an image onto the drop zone, or click it to open the file browser.
3. Fill in the **Description** (this becomes the image alt text — important for SEO).
4. Select a **Category** — Proposals, Graduations, Birthdays, or Studio.
5. Click **Add to Gallery**. The photo is saved to **public/uploads/** and added to **data/photos.json**.

Adding a Photo — Paste URL

Use this tab to add photos already hosted online (e.g. from Google Drive with a direct link, a CDN, or Unsplash).

1. Click the **Paste URL** tab.
2. Paste the full image URL — a small preview will appear below the input.
3. Fill in Description and Category, then click **Add to Gallery**.

Removing a Photo

Hover over any photo card and click **Remove**. A confirmation step appears — click **Confirm** to delete. The photo is removed from **data/photos.json** and, if it was an uploaded file, deleted from **public/uploads/**.

Important Note for Vercel Deployment

Vercel's filesystem is read-only in production. This means:

- Uploaded files saved to **public/uploads/** will **not persist** between deployments.
- Changes to **data/photos.json** made via the admin portal **will not persist** after a redeploy.
- **Solution:** For production use, replace the file-based storage with Vercel Blob (for images) and Vercel KV or a database (for photo metadata). Contact a developer to set this up, or use the URL-tab method to link photos hosted on an external service (e.g. Cloudinary, Google Photos direct links).

5. API Routes

All backend endpoints, their methods, and what they do

Endpoint	Method	Auth Required	Description
GET /api/photos	GET	No	Returns the full list of photos from data/photos.json. Used by the portfolio gallery.
GET /api/admin/photos	GET	Yes	Same as above but requires the x-admin-password header. Used by the admin portal to load photos.
POST /api/admin/photos	POST	Yes	Adds a photo by URL. Body: { src, alt, category }. Returns the updated photo list.
DELETE /api/admin/photos/:id	DELETE	Yes	Removes a photo by ID from data/photos.json. Also deletes the file from public/uploads/ if it exists.
POST /api/admin/upload	POST	Yes	Multipart form upload. Fields: file (image), alt (string), category (string). Saves to public/uploads/ and adds to data/photos.json.

Authentication

All **/api/admin/*** routes check for the header **x-admin-password**. If the value does not match the **ADMIN_PASSWORD** environment variable (default: admin123), the route returns HTTP 401 Unauthorized. This is handled in each route file:

```
const ADMIN_PASSWORD = process.env.ADMIN_PASSWORD ?? "admin123"; function authorized(req) {
  return req.headers.get("x-admin-password") === ADMIN_PASSWORD; }
```

6. Data & Image Management

How photos are stored, read, and written

lib/adminPhotos.ts — Server-Side File Helpers

This file provides four functions used by the API routes to read and write photo data:

readPhotos()	<i>Returns Photo[]</i>	Reads data/photos.json from disk and parses it. Returns an empty array if the file doesn't exist or can't be parsed.
writePhotos(photos)	<i>Returns void</i>	Writes the given Photo[] to data/photos.json with 2-space indentation.
addPhoto(photo)	<i>Returns Photo[]</i>	Calls readPhotos(), appends the new photo, calls writePhotos(), and returns the updated array.
removePhoto(id)	<i>Returns Photo[]</i>	Filters out the photo with the matching ID, writes the result, and returns the updated array.

data/photos.json — The Photo Store

This JSON file is the single source of truth for all gallery images. It is read by **/api/photos** (public) and **/api/admin/photos** (admin). You can edit it directly in a text editor if needed, but the admin portal is the intended interface.

Each photo object follows this structure:

```
{ "id": "p1", // Unique identifier "src": "https://...", // Full URL or /uploads/filename.jpg
  "alt": "Description", // Alt text + admin label "category": "proposals", // proposals |
  graduations | birthdays | studio "width": 1200, // Used by Next/Image for layout "height": 800 //
  Used by Next/Image for layout }
```

lib/photos.ts — Shared Types

Defines the **Photo** interface and **Category** type used throughout the codebase, plus the **heroImages** array for the home page slideshow.

```
export type Category = "proposals" | "graduations" | "birthdays" | "studio"; export interface
Photo { id: string; src: string; alt: string; category: Category; width: number; height: number;
}
```

To add a new category: add it to the **Category** type union, then add a matching entry to the **filters** array in **components/PortfolioGallery.tsx**.

7. Colours, Fonts & Design Tokens

The 'Faded Cinema' palette and typography system

Colour Palette

Name	Hex	Used for
Cream (Background)	#F5F1E8	Page background, light section backgrounds
Deep Slate (Text)	#1C2A5A	Headings, nav links, dark buttons, footer background
Warm Umber (Accent 1)	#624332	Body text, muted labels
Faded Rust (Accent 2)	#A85232	Category labels, hover states, admin accent colour
Border	#E2D9C8	Dividers, table borders, input underlines
Muted	#B8A898	Placeholder text, secondary labels
Admin Dark	#0f1117	Admin portal background

Updating a colour

Colours are used as Tailwind arbitrary values throughout the components, e.g. `text-[#1C2A5A]`. To change a colour site-wide, use Find & Replace in your code editor — search for the hex value and replace all.

The CSS variables in `app/globals.css` are defined for reference:

```
:root { --background: #F5F1E8; --foreground: #1C2A5A; --umber: #624332; --rust: #A85232;
--border: #E2D9C8; --muted: #B8A898; }
```

Typography

Heading font	Tenor Sans — loaded via <code>next/font/google</code> , variable: <code>--font-tenor</code> . Used on all h1, h2, h3 and display text.
Body / UI font	Roboto — loaded via <code>next/font/google</code> , variable: <code>--font-roboto</code> . Used for labels, body copy, buttons, and form elements.
Usage in Tailwind	<code>font-[var(--font-tenor)]</code> and <code>font-[var(--font-roboto)]</code> applied as class names.
Changing fonts	Edit the font imports in <code>app/layout.tsx</code> — replace <code>Tenor_Sans</code> or <code>Roboto</code> with any Google Font, update the variable name, and do a find & replace on the CSS variable name across all files.

8. Deployment to Vercel

How to go live and keep the site updated

First-time deployment

1. Push the project to a GitHub repository.
2. Go to vercel.com and sign in (create a free account if needed).
3. Click **New Project** → Import your GitHub repository.
4. Vercel auto-detects Next.js — leave all settings as default.
5. Add Environment Variable: Key = **ADMIN_PASSWORD**, Value = your chosen password.
6. Click **Deploy**. Your site will be live in ~60 seconds.
7. Optionally connect a custom domain in Project Settings → Domains.

Updating the site after changes

Any **git push** to the main branch automatically triggers a new Vercel deployment. Changes are live within about a minute.

```
git add . git commit -m "Your change description" git push
```

Running locally

```
cd /Users/tmuchato/portfolio_2 npm run dev # Open http://localhost:3000
```

Build check (before deploying)

```
npm run build # Must complete with no errors before pushing
```


9. Common Edits Cheat Sheet

Quick reference — where to go for the most frequent changes

I want to...	Go to...	What to change
Add a gallery photo	/admin portal	Use the Add Photo panel
Remove a gallery photo	/admin portal	Hover photo → Remove → Confirm
Change the admin password	.env.local	ADMIN_PASSWORD=newpassword
Update my bio	app/about/page.tsx	The three tags in the space-y-5 div
Update prices	app/services/page.tsx	The 'from' field in each service object
Add/edit a testimonial	components/TestimonialSlider.tsx	The testimonials array
Change hero images	lib/photos.ts	The heroImages array
Change hero tagline	components/HeroSlideshow.tsx	The h1 element
Update email address	app/contact/page.tsx + components/Footer.tsx	Search for tehillahmuchato@gmail.com
Update Instagram link	app/contact/page.tsx + components/Footer.tsx	Search for tillah.jpg
Change service descriptions	app/services/page.tsx	description field in services array
Add a new service	app/services/page.tsx	Add a new object to the services array
Change nav links	components/Navigation.tsx	The links array at the top
Change footer links	components/Footer.tsx	navLinks and socialLinks arrays
Change the colour palette	All component files	Find & replace hex values e.g. #1C2A5A
Change fonts	app/layout.tsx	Replace the Google Font imports and variable names
Add a new page	app/newpage/page.tsx	Create the file — it becomes /newpage automatically
Update SEO/meta title	app/layout.tsx + each page.tsx	The metadata export at the top of each file
Change slide interval speed	components/HeroSlideshow.tsx	setInterval(next, 6000) — value in ms